May 22, 2026

English Communication I

First Semester Mid-Term Examination

for First-Year Students (60minutes)

Listening

【1】 Listen to the following presentation, and answer the questions below. The recording will be played twice. (2×10)

(1) For each question, select the option from the list below which best matches the content of the presentation.

1) The speaker _____.

a) found the level of his high school education too high for him

b) had a good opportunity to find the object that he took an interest in in college

c) had no trouble adjusting to his environment when he was young.

d) managed to complete his major in computer science

2) American culture _____.

a) allowed the speaker to live as he pleased

b) and Japanese culture seem quite similar to the speaker

c) helped Ema finally find a good American boyfriend

d) provided a job opportunity for Ema

3) Ema _____.

a) appeared on an American TV show and discussed how to boost the economy

b) ended up moving back to the States to marry the speaker

c) was the quiet type of person, and that character appealed to the speaker

d) was unable to communicate with the speaker in English when they met in Oregon State University

4) Oregon State University _____.

a) offered students not only a subject of modern science but also one relating to foreign culture

b) was described by the speaker as one of the most brilliant colleges

c) was of almost the same education level as the high school that the speaker had attended

d) was satisfactory to the speaker except for its course of Japanese culture

5) The speaker's story _____.

a) describes the difficulty of female workers achieving social success

b) explains how difficult it used to be even for local students to graduate from American colleges

c) is about how he has grown both mentally and academically

d) suggests racial and sexual discrimination against Asian people

(2) For each question, select the option from the list below which best matches the content of the presentation.

1) How was the speaker's great grandfather treated by Canadian officials?

a) He was completely left alone.
b) He was denied basic human rights.
c) He was remarkably admired.
d) He was treated rather fairly.

2) Why did the speaker's great grandfather leave Canada?

a) Because he became physically ready to come back.
b) Because he lacked trust from local people.
c) Because his country's domestic industries recovered.
d) Because life there was unbearable.

3) Why did the speaker tell her great grandfather's story?

a) Because she felt sorry for him.
b) For the purpose of apologizing to the audience
c) For the sake of her ancestor's honor
d) In order to compare the past and present social situations

4) Does speaker agree with the idea of Japan's accepting more immigrants?

a) It's impossible to decide from her remarks.
b) She agrees.
c) She disagrees.
d) That depends.

5) Which adjective best describes the speech?

a) Exaggerating
b) Frightening
c) Informational
d) Religious

【2】 Vocabulary (30)

(A) Choose the most appropriate word or phrase to fill in each blank so that each paired the sentences have almost the same meaning. Write the matching letter of the word or phrase on the ANSWER SHEET. (1×6=6)

1) Look at the figures in the table. ≒ Look at the (1) in the table.
a. numbers b. letters c. information d. explanations

2) She can speak Chinese, English, and even Japanese.
≒She can speak Japanese (2) Chinese and English.
a. except b. without c. besides d. above

3) The way he speaks is different from mine. ≒His (3) of speaking is different from mine.
a. purpose b. manner c. reason d. relation

4) The flight was canceled because of bad weather. ≒The flight was canceled (4) bad weather.
a. in the case of b. due to c. instead of d. in honor of

5) His parents are really worried about his safety. ≒ His parents are (5) his safety.
a. exhausted by b. frustrated with c. annoyed by d. anxious about

6) She fully understands how important it is to study hard. ≒ She (6) how important it is to study hard.
a. appreciates b. demands c. admits d. remarks

(B) Fill in the blank space in English sentence below so that each sentence has the meaning that matches the Japanese sentence. If the first letter is given, use it. Write your answer on the ANSWER SHEET. (2×6=12, 部分点なし)

1) 市民たちはダムの建設に抗議している。
Citizens are (p) (a) the construction of the dam.

2) 彼女は三時間テレビを見た。
She (s) three hours (w) TV.

3) 彼らは遅れずに到着するだろう。
They will arrive (w) (d).

4) トム(Tom)は車の運転に慣れている。
Tom is ( ) ( ) driving.

5) その研究者はその理論を別の分野にも応用している。
The researcher (ap) the theory ( ) another field.

6) 一つのことに長時間集中するのが苦手だ。
It's hard for me to (c) ( ) one thing for a long time.

(C) Read the passage below and answer the following questions. Write your answer on the ANSWER SHEET.

Some people claim that English education in Japan needs to develop students' speaking abilities more. However, (1)most high school students don't need speaking skills to pass entrance exams for universities. Then, can we argue that they don't need to be able to speak English at all? Indeed (2) studying just for the sake of entrance exams lacks the true purpose of studying English.

3.In this (m) society, there are a lot of (o) to work together with people who (d) from us. 【現代社会には、私たちと異なる人々と共に活動する機会が多くある】 If you aim to succeed after graduating from university and entering global society, it is not enough that they have a large vocabulary or grammar knowledge. They should be able to communicate with people from different cultures and this is the (4)major reason why you should improve your speaking skills as well.

1. Select the sentence that has almost the same meaning as underlined parts (1) and (2). Write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (2×2)

(1)

a. To enter universities, students don't benefit from anything except speaking skills.
b. Speaking ability appears to be needed to be admitted to common universities.
c. Students' speaking skills rarely matter to pass their entrance exams for universities.
d. It is not unusual for entrance exams for universities to include speaking tests.

(2)

a. When students study simply to pass entrance exams, they don't understand the true aim of studying.
b. Most students make an effort only when they need to prepare for the entrance examination.
c. The idea that students don't need speaking ability to enter good universities is completely wrong.
d. In order to pass entrance exams, they should understand why they are studying.

2.Fill in the blanks so that the sentence matches the Japanese translation. Use the first letters given. (2×3)
【日本語訳】現代社会には、私たちと異なる人々と共に活動する機会が多くある。
In this (m) society, there are a lot of (o) to work together with people who (d) from us.

3.Select the most appropriate word which has the closest meaning of "major" here. Write a matching letter and write on the ANSWER SHEET. (2)

a. certain b. famous c. natural d. main

【3】 **Read the passage below and answer the following questions。** (18)

Imagine that it's raining. Is it pouring: *zaa-zaa* ? Or is it drizzling: *shito-shito* ? Or is it sprinkling: *potsuri-potsuri* ? These words, onomatopoeia, evoke images in our minds. Our ALT will guide us through the world of onomatopoeia.

Good morning. Welcome to the exciting world of onomatopoeia! Maybe you are wondering, "What's that fancy word?" Well, it's basically about sounds—like *buzz* for a bee or *splash* for water. Onomatopoeia helps us create vivid images in our minds.

(A) Japanese is famous for (1.a / 2.so / 3.having / 4.of / 5.range /6.wide) onomatopoeic words. You often come (a) these words in manga, anime, and even in the names of snacks. Snack names often include words like *saku-saku*, *pari-pari*, and *fuwa-fuwa*. When you hear *saku-saku*, what comes (b) mind? Maybe cookies. And how about *pari-pari*? Perhaps rice crackers. What about *fuwa-fuwa*? Possibly something soft, like a pancake.

Using these words truly adds flavor to our lives. When you hear these words, you may want to eat something delicious. Onomatopoeia is all around us and adds a touch (c) magic to our language and experiences. (B) It (1.exciting / 2.more / 3.everyday life / 4.excited / 5.our / 6.makes).

Onomatopoeia is something special in the world of words. For most words, there is no natural connection between their sounds and meanings. For example, (C)the word for a cat doesn't have to be *cat*; it could be *neko*, like in Japanese. In the case of onomatopoeia, however, there is a close connection between sounds and meanings. This means that onomatopoeia can help people understand each other across language boundaries.

Let's compare onomatopoeic pairs in Japanese and English in Table 1. You will notice that some of the sounds are quite similar. However, (D)this (1. always / 2.is / 3.for / 4. case / 5. not /6. the). Actually, onomatopoeic words with similar sounds in Japanese and English are rather rare. In fact, most onomatopoeic words sound different in the two languages. Check out the examples in Table 2

Table 1. Onomatopoeia with similar sounds in Japanese and English

Japanese	English
wan-wan（ワンワン）	bow-wow /bàuwáu/
nyaao（ニャーオ）	meow /miáu/
moo（モー）	moo /mú:/
ban（バン）	bang /bǽŋ/
pochan（ポチャン）	plop /pláp/

Table 2. Onomatopoeia with different sounds in Japanese and English

Japanese	English
kero-kero（ケロケロ）	ribbit /rɪ́bɪt/
gaa-gaa（ガーガー）	quack /kwǽk/
goro-goro（ゴロゴロ）	rumble /rʌ́mbəl/
potari-potari（ポタリポタリ）	drip-drop /drípdrɑ̀p/
pacha（パチャ）	splash /splǽʃ/

At first, speakers of Japanese may find English onomatopoeia rather strange. As you get used to it, it will start to make sense. So, give it a try, and you'll begin to enjoy it and understand it more deeply as time goes by.

The difference between Japanese and English onomatopoeia goes (d) just sounds. In Japanese, verbs often come along with onomatopoeic words. (E)They act like adverbs to describe manners of action. As you can see in Table 3, the basic verb *aruku*, preceded by an onomatopoeic word to modify it, describes unique manners of walking. On the other hand, English has a variety of verbs to describe walking.

Table 3. Different types of walking in Japanese and English

Japanese	English
yoro-yoro aruku （ヨロヨロ歩く）	hobble /hɑ bəl/
tobo-tobo aruku （トボトボ歩く）	plod /plɑ´d/
bura-bura aruku （ブラブラ歩く）	stroll /stróul/
koso-koso aruku （コソコソ歩く）	tiptoe /tɪ´ptòu/
yochi-yochi aruku （ヨチヨチ歩く）	toddle /tɑ´dəl/

Table 4. Different types of laughing in Japanese and English

Japanese	English
kusutto warau （クスッと笑う）	chuckle /tʃʌkəl/
kusu-kusu warau （クスクス笑う）	giggle /gɪ´gəl/
niyarito warau （ニヤリと笑う）	grin /grɪ´n/
gera-gera warau （ゲラゲラ笑う）	guffaw /gʌfɔ:/
kusurito warau （クスリと笑う）	titter /tɪ´tər/

You can find similar differences in expressions of laughter. Take a look at Table 4.

Well, class, that's it for today. We have seen that Japanese and English use onomatopoeia in their own unique ways. Language is like a colorful mosaic, and onomatopoeia is one of its brightest pieces. Let's continue exploring the world of onomatopoeia! There's always something new to discover.

1) **Find the word in the passage that matches the definition in a) and write it down.** （1点）

a) to bring a memory, feeling, or image into the mind

2) **In each blank (A)(B)and (D) remove the one unnecessary word from the 6 words and rearrange the remaining five words. Write the numbers of the words that comes to** 2nd **and** 5th **place.** （1点×3）

3) **Write the most appropriate preposition to fill in the blank from (a) to(d) ※preposition 前置詞** （1点×4）

4) **Select two options from the list below that match the content of the passage.** （完答2点）

1. Onomatopoeia is an expression that comes from sound.
2. Onomatopoeia is used only in the names of snacks.
3. Onomatopoeia isn't used much today.
4. Onomatopoeia is used more often in English than in Japanese.
5. Onomatopoeia is usually used in our everyday life.

5) **Choose the most appropriate explanation for the meaning of the phrase "(C)The word for a cat."** （1点）

1. It is a common example of onomatopoeia.
2. It has no natural connection between its sound and meaning.
3. It is one which is understood across language boundaries.
4. It comes from the Japanese word *neko.*

6) According to the passage, what is the most appropriate characteristic of Japanese onomatopoeia? (2点)

1. Onomatopoeic words often modify verbs.
2. Onomatopoeic words often work as verbs.
3. You often see a pair of onomatopoeic words.
4. Verbs are hardly used with onomatopoeic words.

7) What does Table 3 tell you? (2点)

1. When you walk fast, you plod.
2. There are only five types of walking in English.
3. English describes manners of walking by using a variety of adverbs.
4. English describes manners of walking by using a variety of verbs.

8) Translate the underlined part (E) into Japanese. (Make it clear what "They" refers to) (3点)

【4】Read the passage and answer the following questions (2点×4)

Onomatopoeia means words that imitate sounds. In English, examples include buzz, meow, and bang. These words are special because they not only carry meaning, but their sounds also resemble the things they describe. According to linguists, onomatopoeia is a link between sound and sense.

In Japanese, onomatopoeia is used more often than in English. It includes not only sounds made by animals or objects, but also feelings and movements. For instance, both English and Japanese have an onomatopoeia to reproduce the sound of a barking dog, respectively "woof" and "*wan-wan*". However, Japanese language also includes onomatopoeia that does not exist in English, such as *waku-waku* to show excitement. This can only be translated with an adjective in English. The second type is called *mimetics* or *ideophones*. This kind of words help speakers express emotions and sensations quickly and vividly.

Korean also uses many ideophones. For example, *mung-mung* is a dog's bark, *banjjak-banjjak* means something sparkling, and *dugeun-dugeun* describes a fast heartbeat when you are nervous or excited. Like Japanese, Korean ideophones can repeat sounds to show intensity.

English uses onomatopoeia less in everyday speech, and mainly for actual sounds. We say ***clang*** for a loud metallic noise or ***splash*** for something hitting a water surface. English rarely uses it for feelings or textures, so speakers often need extra adjectives instead.

These differences show that onomatopoeia is not the same in every language. In Japanese and Korean, it is part of daily conversation and covers a wide range of meanings. In English, it is more limited but still adds vivid detail. As linguist Dingemanse says, ideophones "create a vivid sensory image in the mind of the hearer."

By learning onomatopoeia in different languages, we can express ourselves in fresh, creative ways – and understand the unique rhythms of each culture's communication. 注 adjective 形容詞

Choose the most appropriate answer to each question below

1) Onomatopoeia means special words that
   a) imitate the sounds of certain English words.
   b) don't carry any meaning but only describe sounds.
   c) have similar sounds to the object they represent.
   d) were invented by linguists.

2) According to the passage ideophones

a) are referred to as a type of onomatopoeia, especially for sounds made by animals.

b) reproduce the same sound in both English and Japanese.

c) cannot be translated from English to Korean without adjectives.

d) enable us to convey clear images of how we feel about something.

3) Onomatopoeia in English is used

a) for feelings and textures rather than actual sounds.

b) to describe specific sounds in detail.

c) instead of adding extra adjectives.

d) in limited situations that cause vivid emotions.

4) Which of the following is NOT correct about onomatopoeia?

a) It can connects what we hear with what we feel.

b) Learning it in a different language needs knowledge of English adjectives.

c) It helps not only speakers express but also hearers imagine something.

d) We can make ourselves understood impressively by using it.

【5】 Read the following passage and answer the questions (12)

Harry: Welcome to the Harry Nilson Show. Today's guest is Yoko Shimada, a Japanese influencer who makes a splash among teenagers. First of all, you were born and raised in a Japanese environment, but what brought you here to the States?

Yoko: Honestly, I wonder where I belong, even now. Anyway, Japanese culture is collective and focuses on group harmony, rather than an individual self. Most children may get used to these morals, but this is not (b). There are always some exceptions, and they have an extraordinarily hard time in Japanese culture. That's why I decided to move to the States right after I graduated from high school, but even now, that memory of loneliness and anxiety suddenly comes back, and it feels tiring to be alive. All of them can be called a journey of exploring a self.

Harry: You mean that your journey of exploration involves anxiety?

Yoko: Precisely, anxiety set the journey off. My parents always suggested that I might (a) take it easy, not seriously, but I needed to live my life in my own manner because it best fits me. I stepped out of Japan. I boarded a 737 for the West Coast, and landed in Southern California. Of course, I had nobody to count on there, so I had to feel safe and secure for myself. I came across a signboard for Pasadena City College. Super-luckily, the girl at the reception kindly told me everything I'd need to survive there, ranging from a dorm to financial aid. I applied for admission on the spot.

I started to attend the college. In order to (c) with the rest of the class, I needed to rely on human resources, including librarians and counselors. They all made every effort to support me both academically and mentally. I owed a lot to those people. I felt grateful to other people and understood their emotions for the first time in life. It was during my college days that I realized something about human nature and appreciated its importance. I assumed that there were lots of discriminatory issues in the U.S., but I discovered that American people admire anyone devoted, regardless of their race and gender.

I also had to earn money. I had lots of job interviews, but I failed. One day, a librarian advised me to add impressive examples, in order to make my story sound vivid. Her tips turned out to work. I landed a well-paid job.

Harry: That story reminds me of your way of attracting viewers of your social media uploads.

Yoko: Yeah. I started to post my real episodes vividly, with a help from that librarian. I soon got to know that there

were tons of people who faced identity crises, just like me. Time flies. It's been about five years since my first posting. Now, millions of my followers and I [2-1] every day through my online platforms. I take great pride in these achievements of mine.

Harry : Thank you so much for your thrilling story, Yoko. We [2-2] its share of hardships, and that your achievement has been serving, and [2-3], as a brilliantly burning flame of hope for everyone who feels out of place.

1) For numbered blank spaces (1-1) to (1-3), select the most appropriate option, and write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (1 点×3)

a) allowed me b) always the case c) as well d) emphasize e) fulfill my requirements f) keep up

2) For numbered blank spaces [2-1] to [2-3], select the most appropriate option, and write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (1 点×3)

a) can see that your life had b) inspire one another c) were determined to go ahead d) will continue to act

3) For each numbered question 3-1) to 3-3) below, select the most appropriate answer and write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (2 点× 3)

3-1) **Why did Yoko leave Japan immediately after her graduation from high school?**

a) Because of lack of self-confidence.
b) Due to her physical disability.
c) For the purpose of improving her language skill.
d) To avoid facing unbearable stress.

3-2) **How did her experience of attending community college change Yoko?**

a) It allowed her to forget all about her awful memories.
b) It helped her first empathize with people around her.
c) She discovered who she really is.
d) She learned the importance of earning money.

3-3) **What does Harry think of Yoko's success as an influencer?**

a) He believes that she is bound to continue acting like a reliable guide for people who find life painful.
b) He claims that her success has brought prosperity to American social media.
c) He insists on her being misunderstood by a lot of her followers.
d) He remarks that she is likely to get an American citizenship, even though it's rare for Japanese people to do so.

【6】 Read the following passage and answer the questions (12)

In 2020, people all over the world faced an unexpected hardship that they had never experienced before — COVID-19, which was a totally new type of virus at the time (a). At first, its fatality[1] rate was about 6.0%, and it was even 25% for elderly people over the age of 70. (A)It took away (　) many lives (　) the whole world was frightened.

COVID-19 was a highly contagious[2]. virus. When people became infected[3] and were hospitalized, (B)(　　)(release) from the hospital was rather hard for them. Some patients were not allowed to see their families until their death, or even after death, to prevent the spread of the illness (b).

In 2023, the fatality rate of COVID-19 became 0.24%. We overcame this difficulty (c). However, we should never forget that (C)medical staff took care of suffering patients and struggled to find better treatments in the face of the adversity. It must have been a long and difficult journey for them (d).

We will probably face challenge after challenge in the future. We all need to be determined to work together as a global community and move forward in any situation, just as people did during the COVID-19 pandemic[4] (e).

fatality rate[1]＝致死率

contagious[2]=感染性の

infected[3]=感染した

pandemic[4]＝病気などの大流行

1) Fill in the blanks with appropriate words so that the underlined sentence (A) has almost the same meaning as the sentence below. Write your answer on the ANSWER SHEET. (1)

The whole world was frightened because it took away quite many lives.

→(A) It took away (　) many lives (　) the whole world was frightened.

2) Fill in the first blank (B) with appropriate word. For the second blank, change the form of the verb "release". (2)

3) Select the most appropriate place from (a) to (e), to put the phrase "regardless of their wishes." Write the matching letter on the ANSWER SHEET. (2)

4) Translate underlined part (C) into Japanese. Write your answer on the ANSWER SHEET. (3)

5) Which option in the list below is NOT mentioned in the passage above? Write the matching number of the appropriate option on the ANSWER SHEET. (2)

1. Getting infected with COVID-19 was extremely dangerous for elderly people.
2. In 2023, even when COVID-19 patients were hospitalized, their doctors usually allowed to leave the hospital right away.
3. COVID-19 killed a quarter of infected patients over 70 years old at the beginning of the pandemic.
4. COVID-19 patients were not able to go outside as they pleased.

6) Which option in the list below is mentioned in this passage? Write the matching number of the appropriate option on your answer sheet. (2)

1. We owe a lot to medical staff for overcoming the pandemic.
2. Medical treatments were not helpful to save patients during the pandemic.
3. We can assume that we are safe until the end of time, now that we have overcome COVID-19.
4. People forgot about the efforts of medical staff over time.